

From a screenshot to a sample.

Your hub is one private room for every product you develop with us: start a tech pack from a photo, let the assistant draft it, submit it, approve the finished version, pay the sample deposit, and follow sampling — all in one place, built for your phone.

- 01 Add a screenshot or photo of what you want made.
- 02 The assistant builds the tech pack in about a minute. You check it and submit. First one free; then \$48 a pack or \$100 a month.
- 03 Future Basics finishes it and publishes v1. You approve and sign.
- 04 You get a quote and a deposit invoice. Pay it and sampling begins.

STEP BY STEP

Starting a tech pack

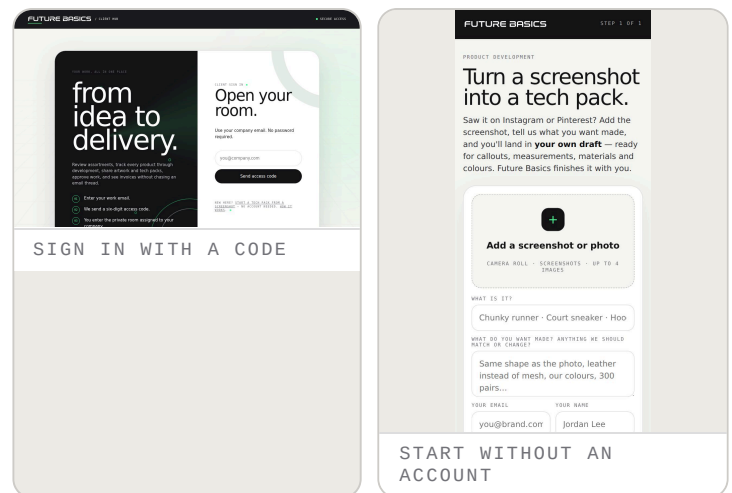
Step 01

Sign in — or start without an account

Your room is private to your company. Enter your work email and we send a six-digit code. There are no passwords.

New to Future Basics? You do not need a room first. Open hub.thefuturebasics.com/start on your phone, add a screenshot and your email, and your room is created around your first tech pack.

Tip: save the hub to your phone's home screen. Everything here is designed for a phone first.

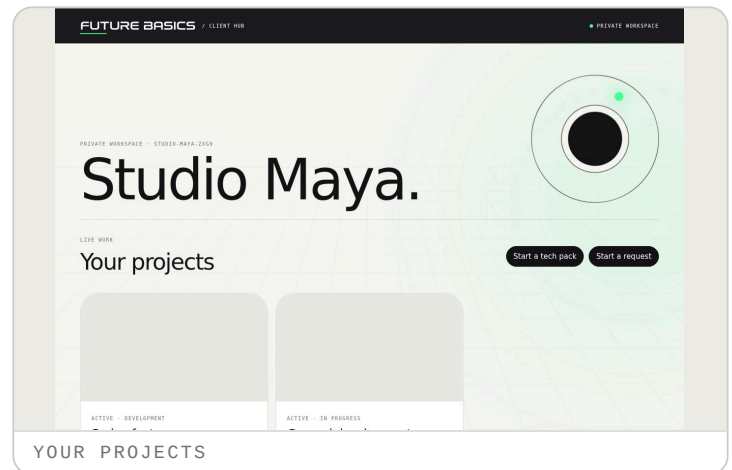


Step 02

Press “Start a tech pack”

From your projects page, press **Start a tech pack**. You can also start one from inside any project page.

Use **Start a request** for anything that is not a new product: artwork, a change to a product in development, or a question.

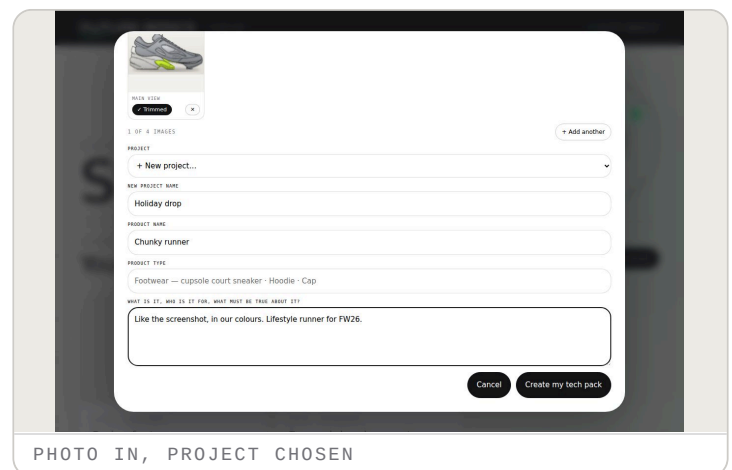


Step 03

Add a screenshot, choose a project

Saw it on Instagram or Pinterest? Screenshot it. App bars and captions are trimmed automatically; the product is what we keep. Add up to four images — the first is the main view.

- Pick one of your projects or type a name to create a new one.
- Give the product a working name. Everything else is optional.
- Wrong file? Press the **x** on its thumbnail. Once you are in the editor, the **x** in the photo's corner swaps it.
- No photo? Press **Create blank draft** and fill the pack in yourself.

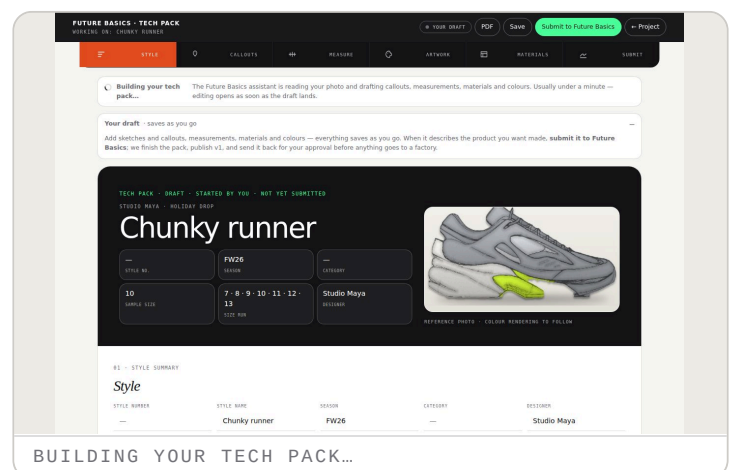


Step 04

The assistant builds your tech pack

You land in your draft straight away with the banner **Building your tech pack...** For about a minute the editor is read-only while the assistant reads the photo and drafts callouts, measurements, materials and colours; it unlocks the moment the draft lands.

If the photo cannot be read — nothing recognisable in frame, too small, too blurry — you are told why, with a **Try again** button and the option to swap the photo. We are notified too.

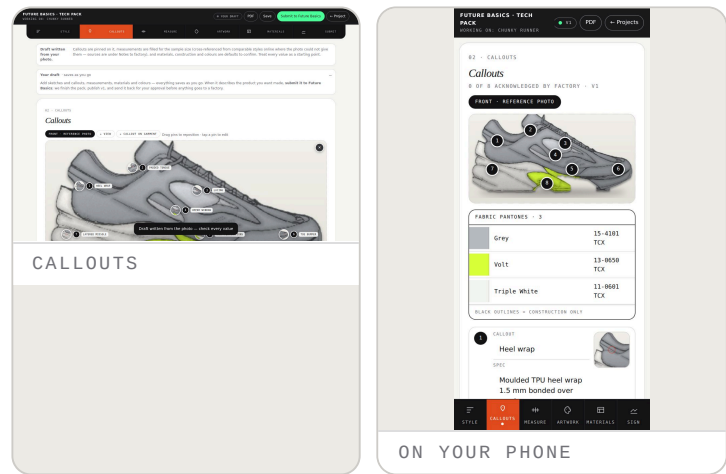


Step 05

Check the callouts

Callouts are the details a factory must get right. The assistant pins them on your photo — usually eight to twelve — each with a cropped close-up, a spec and a note to the factory.

- Tap a pin or a card to edit it. Drag a pin to move it.
- Add your own with **+ Callout on garment**, then tap the spot.
- Everything saves as you go.



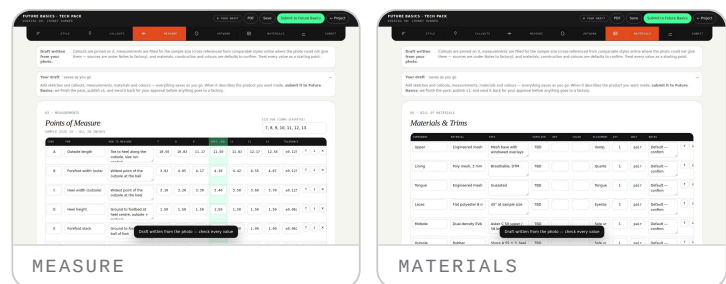
Step 06

Measurements, materials, colours

The assistant fills the measurement table for your sample size and grades it across the size run, drafts materials and trims with best-practice defaults, lists construction steps, and reads the colours off the photo with Pantone references.

When the photo cannot give a measurement, the assistant looks the style up online — retailer listings, size charts, lab measurements of the same or comparable products — fills the row from what it finds, and lists the sources under **Notes to factory**. Products with no standard template get their points of measure proposed the same way.

Every value is a starting point. Change anything; what you type wins.



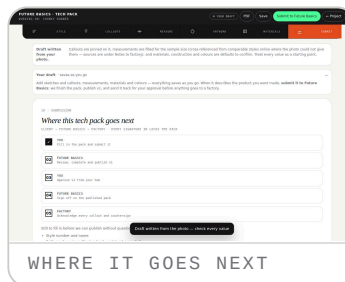
Step 07

Submit to Future Basics

When the draft describes the product you want made, press **Submit**. The Submit tab shows what is still thin; you can submit anyway and we fill the gaps with you.

While we work on it the draft is read-only. Need to change something? Message us in the project thread and we hand it back.

Your first tech pack is on us. From the second one, the assistant and Submit unlock for **\$48** a pack, or **\$100 a month** for unlimited packs with the studio membership. The choice opens right there; payment is a Shopify checkout showing your photo, and the pack unlocks the moment it clears. Filling a draft in by hand is always free.



WHERE IT GOES NEXT

UNLOCKING A LATER PACK

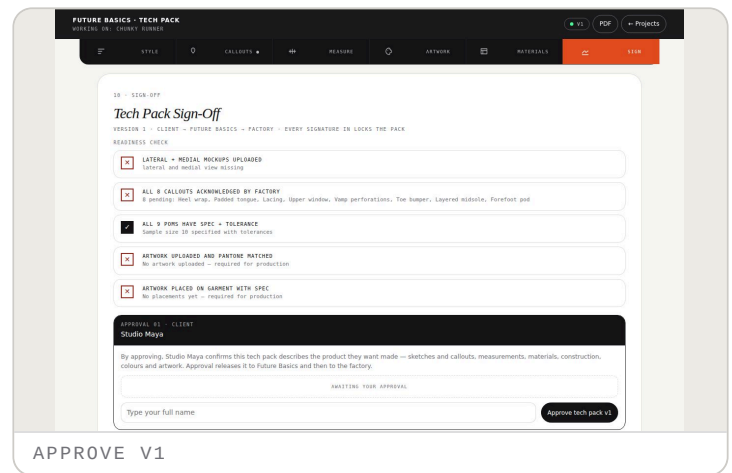
Review, approval, deposit, sample

Step 08

We publish v1 — you approve and sign

Future Basics reviews your draft, completes it and publishes version 1 to your room. You get an email. Open the pack, go to **Sign**, read it through, type your full name and press **Approve**.

Your approval is your signature. It confirms the tech pack describes the product you want made and releases it to Future Basics, then to the factory.

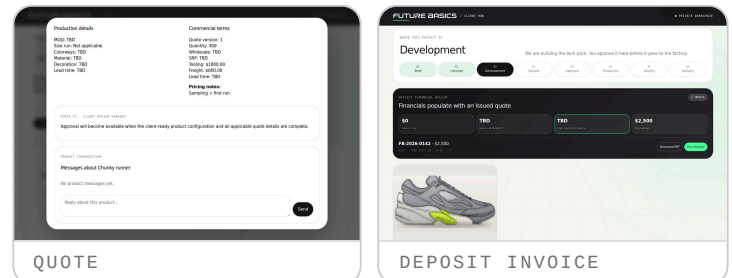


Step 09

Approve the quote, pay the sample deposit

Once v1 is approved, we issue a quote for sampling on the product's page in your room — quantity, unit cost, tooling and freight. Press **Approve quote**.

The deposit invoice then appears in the project's financial rollup with **Download PDF** and a **Pay** link. Sampling starts when the deposit is paid; the invoice shows as paid in your room.



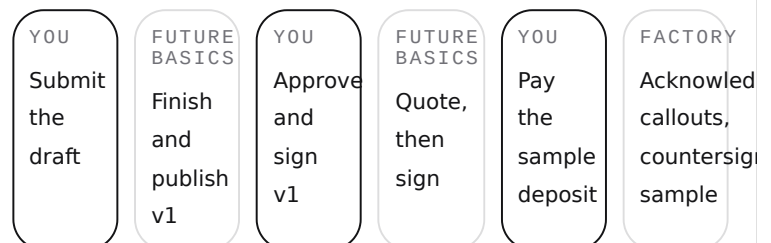
Step 10

Sampling

The factory works from the published tech pack through a private link: it acknowledges every callout and countersigns. With every signature in, the pack locks — any change after that is a new version, and the chain starts again.

You follow progress in the project room: messages, files, milestones and the sample photos as they arrive.

THE SIGN-OFF CHAIN



From one photo

Product and category

What it is, its construction and signature details, in two to four sentences.

Callouts with close-ups

Eight to twelve details pinned on the photo, each with a crop, a spec and a factory note.

Measurements

The right template for the product type, filled for the sample size and graded across the run, with the basis stated.

Materials and trims

Best-practice defaults for the product type, marked as defaults to confirm.

Construction

How it is made, step by step, in factory language.

Colours

Observed colours with hex and Pantone TCX references, plus suggested alternatives flagged as suggestions.

Care and notes

Care instructions, assumptions, what the photo does not show, and open questions for you.

Clean reference

The product is cropped out of the screenshot for the cover and tiles; your original stays as a view.

Questions we get

Do I need an account to start?

No. Open [/start](#), add a screenshot and your email, and your room is created with your first tech pack in it. The next time you come back, we email you a six-digit code — there are no passwords.

What kind of photo works best?

One product, filling most of the frame, side-on if it is footwear. Screenshots from Instagram or Pinterest are fine: app bars and captions are trimmed off automatically, and the assistant crops to the product. You can add up to four images; the first is the main view, the rest are detail views.

How long does the draft take?

Usually under two minutes. The banner reads “Building your tech pack...”; the editor is read-only while the assistant works and unlocks the moment the draft lands. If it takes longer than three minutes, editing opens anyway and the draft merges in when it arrives.

Will I lose what I typed if the assistant is still working?

No. Anything you type wins: your edits are kept field by field, your callouts come first, and the assistant's are added around them.

It says the photo could not be read. Now what?

The banner tells you why. Swap the photo under **Callouts** → **View settings** → **Replace image**, then press **Try again** (up to three times). You will also get an email with the same guidance, and we are notified so we can help. Or just reply to the email with a better picture and we take it from there.

I uploaded the wrong photo. Can I swap it?

Yes, at every stage. Before you create the draft, press the x on the thumbnail. In the editor, press the x in the corner of the photo under **Callouts**: the photo clears, the drop zone comes back, and the callouts stay listed (unpinned) until the right photo is in. A new first photo offers to have the assistant read it again; anything you typed is kept.

Where do measurements come from when the photo cannot show them?

From the same or comparable styles online. The assistant identifies the product, looks up retailer listings, brand size charts and lab measurements, converts to inches for your sample size, and lists every source under Notes to factory. Rows it cannot anchor are left open rather than guessed, and nothing is final until a physical sample confirms it.

Is the draft accurate?

It is a strong starting point, not a spec. Measurements are read from the photo's proportions and anchored to category norms; materials are best-practice defaults. Every value is labelled as a draft, and nothing is released to a factory until you, Future Basics and the factory have all signed.

Can I start a tech pack without a photo, or add sketches later?

Yes. Press **Create blank draft** to get the empty template, and add views under Callouts at any time. Future Basics can also run the assistant on a pack later once a photo or sketch is on it.

What happens after I submit?

We review it, complete anything missing, and publish version 1 to your room, usually within two business days. You get an email. The draft is read-only while we work; message us in the project thread if you need it back.

How do I approve and sign?

Open the published tech pack, go to the **Sign** tab, type your full name and press **Approve**. That is your signature. The chain is you → Future Basics → factory; every signature in locks the pack.

What does a tech pack cost?

Your first tech pack is free. After that, each pack is **\$48**, or the **studio membership** is **\$100 a month** for unlimited packs, re-runs and Mandarin exports. The price covers the assistant's draft from your photo and Future Basics' review and v1 publish; you can fill a draft in by hand at no cost, and unlock it when you are ready to submit. Once a project in your room has a paid sample deposit, every pack is included. Payment is through Shopify checkout; the assistant starts the moment it clears.

When do I pay for sampling, and how much?

Review of your submitted pack costs nothing. After you approve v1 we issue a quote for sampling on the product page. Approve the quote and the deposit invoice appears in the project's financial rollup with a PDF and a Pay link. Sampling starts once the deposit is paid. Production terms follow the sample.

I want to change something after signing.

Tell us in the project thread. Any change to a signed pack is published as a new version, and the approvals start again so everyone signs what the factory will actually make.

Who can see my tech pack?

You and Future Basics. Factories only ever see the published version, through private links we create and can revoke at any time. They never see your drafts or your room.

Will the factory understand it?

Yes. Factory links carry the published pack with every callout, measurement and material, and Future Basics can hand it over in Mandarin with one press. Codes, numbers and Pantone references stay as written.

What are colour renderings?

Photo-realistic views of your product in each colourway, made by Future Basics from the Pantone selections in the pack. The first one becomes the cover of the tech pack and the image on your project tiles.

Can I get a PDF?

Yes. Press **PDF** in the tech pack's top bar to print the whole pack. Project collections and invoices also download as PDFs from the project page.

I started one and never came back. What happens?

We send one reminder a few hours later with the link to your draft. Reply to that email with what you want made and we build the tech pack for you.

The screenshot is of another brand's product. Is that a problem?

Reference photos are for inspiration. The assistant describes construction generically and never copies logos or trademarks; the tech pack is for your original product. Tell us what to keep and what to change.

Does this work on my phone?

It is built for it. Pins show as numbers; tap one to open its card. Tables become cards. Screenshots upload straight from your camera roll.

NEED A HAND?

Message us in any project thread in your room, or reply to any email from us. If something in a draft looks wrong, tell us there — we fix it with you before anything goes to a factory.